

► CHALLENGER 1 MBT

Date 1983 Origin UK

Weight 62 tonnes (68.3 tons)

Length 11.5m (37¾ft)

Top speed 56kph (35mph)

Engine Rolls-Royce 12-cylinder 895kW (1,200hp) diesel engine

Manned by four crew, the Challenger 1 was one of the first armoured vehicles to use Chobham ceramic composite armour. It was a considerable improvement over the underpowered Chieftain tank, and has now been superseded by the Challenger 2.



◄ M1A1 ABRAMS MBT

Date 1986 Origin US

Weight 61.3 tonnes (67.5 tons)

Length 7.93m (26ft)

Top speed 67kph (42mph)

Engine Honeywell 1,120kW (1,500hp) multi-fuel turbine engine

The four-man M1A1 has become the US Army's MBT, seeing service in the 1991 Gulf War and the 2003 invasion of Iraq. Its main armament has been upgraded from the M1's 105mm gun, and it features a gas-turbine engine.



◄ LEOPARD C2

Date 2000 Origin West Germany

Weight 42 tonnes (46.2 tons)

Length 8.29m (27¼ft)

Top speed 65kph (40mph)

Engine MB 838 10-cylinder 610kW (819hp) multi-fuel engine

Developed in West Germany during the 1960s, the Leopard 1 proved to be a highly effective MBT. Several models were created for export, such as the improved C2 version that was adopted by the Canadian Army, among others.



◄ T90 MBT

Date 1993 Origin Russia

Weight 47.5 tonnes (52.3 tons)

Length 9.63m (31½ft)

Top speed 65kph (40mph)

Engine V-84 12-cylinder 618kW (840hp) diesel engine

An evolutionary design based on the T72, the three-man T90 is the Russian army's MBT. It includes a new main gun, an increased array of electronic devices, and greatly improved armour protection.